

**“DREAMS ARE
ILLUSTRATIONS . . . FROM
THE BOOK YOUR SOUL IS
WRITING ABOUT YOU.”**

Marsha Norman (1947–),
American author



SLEEP PARALYSIS

People affected by sleep paralysis sometimes wake up to find that their bodies will not move. Scientists believe that this occurs because during normal REM sleep, the body is paralyzed to prevent someone from acting out their dreams and injuring themselves. Though the brain has woken up, the body remains frozen in a dream.

NIGHTMARES

We've all woken up, shaken and sweating, from a nightmare. These bad dreams affect children in particular. In the past, people believed that nightmares were evidence of evil magic. Today, scientists blame stress, trauma, emotional problems, or illness. Despite this, some people have regular nightmares unrelated to their waking lives. Studies have found that these people may be more sensitive and emotional.

SLEEPWALKING

Walking while asleep is a mild sleep disorder. Sleep scientists call it a “partial awakening” because the brain is partly awake and partly asleep. Most people do not remember the sleepwalking once they wake up. Some scientists claim that there is a genetic link between instances of sleepwalking in families. A minority of people also eat, bathe, dress, and even drive cars while asleep.



HIDDEN MEANINGS

Some people believe that dreams contain meanings and messages, and if we could interpret and understand them, our lives would make more sense. They could be predicting events or pointing out possibilities for the future, but we have yet to recognize their significance.

we cannot consciously face. Dreams make people aware of these issues so that they can address them.

OUTSIDE STIMULI

Evidence suggests that the brain registers external stimuli, such as a car alarm, and tries to incorporate this into a dream. Many people have experienced this themselves when, for example, someone is calling their name in a dream and they wake up to find someone trying to wake them.

PRIVATE PROBLEMS

Other people claim that dreams are a way of revealing the problems that

